

Symbolic directions

In symbolic directions, all factors in the natal chart are advanced each year by a value of approximately 1 degree — the daily movement of the Sun. That is why they are also commonly known as 'Solar arc directions'.

Calculation and time key

You will encounter several time keys for symbolic directions, but the most important are:

- 1° per year.
- the mean daily motion of the Sun.
- the actual motion of the Sun over several days.

The last variant corresponds to the Sun as measured in secondary directions.

To calculate a symbolic direction for a specific moment, you determine the number of years — including fraction — since birth, and multiply that by the chosen time key. The result is added to the longitude of each factor in the horoscope.

No declinations

This motion is purely symbolic and not astronomical. It is therefore not really possible to calculate declinations.

History

The German astrologers Alfred Witte and Reinhold Ebertin popularised symbolic directions, or solar arc directions. They used these directions particularly in combination with midpoints.

Their popularity was also aided by the fact that these directions shared something in common with primary directions but were much simpler to calculate.



1. Ebertin, Reinhold - *Direktionen - Mitgestalter des Schicksals* (German). Freiburg im Breisgau, 1973.
2. Tyl, Noel - *Solar arcs. Astrology's most succesfull predictive system*. St. Paul, Minnesota, 2001,